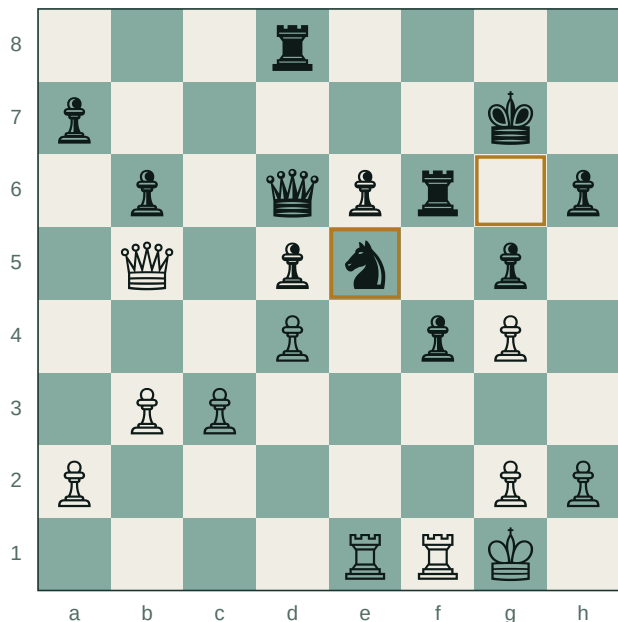


Forks and double attacks: White, move 30

Forks and double attacks

White to move



Previous move: 29...Nxe5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30. dxe5 Qc5+ 31. Qxc5 bxc5 32. exf6+

30.dxe5 The pawn captures the knight on e5. From e5 it attacks queen on d6 and rook on f6. Recorded reply: **30...Qc5+.**

31.Qxc5 The queen captures the queen on c5. Recorded reply: **31...bxc5.**

32.exf6+ Check restricts Black to 7 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from -3 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on g7. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.